

DEER HUNTING USA

Sammy Light-Gun Hunting Arcade — Service & Placement Guide Cabinet • Light Gun • Monitor • Reliability for public use

Prepared for **Coin Op 4 Charity** / Arcade Angels
Keeping a classic hunting light-gun game reliable and inviting for community spaces

1. Overview & Goals

Deer Hunting USA (Sammy USA, circa 2000) is a single-player light-gun hunting arcade game. It uses a CRT monitor and an optical light gun — the gun relies on the CRT's scanning characteristics for accurate aiming. For public and youth-center placements the priorities are reliable gun tracking, a stable picture, clean presentation, and simple ongoing care. Note: because the light gun is CRT-dependent, converting the monitor to LCD usually breaks or severely degrades gun accuracy unless a specialized solution is used.

2. Safety

- Unplug the cabinet before any internal work.
- CRT monitors store high voltage. Discharge the anode properly before working on the chassis or neckboard.
- Treat the light gun and its cable with care — internal wiring and the optical sensor are common failure points.
- Keep the work area organized so small parts and screws do not become hazards inside the cabinet.

3. Cabinet Exterior & Cosmetics

- Clean the entire cabinet thoroughly. Remove sticky residue, dust, and years of hand prints.
- Inspect side art, front decals, bezel, and any control-panel graphics. Replace or carefully restore heavily damaged sections so the machine looks cared for.
- Marquee: clean the plastic and replace the fluorescent tube or lighting if dim. A bright marquee makes the game far more inviting.
- Coin door: clean, lubricate, confirm locks or convert/document free-play status for the placement site.
- Level the cabinet so it sits solidly.

4. Light Gun — Highest Priority for Playability

Accurate gun tracking is the entire player experience on this machine.

- Clean the gun exterior and the optical lens/window thoroughly. Dust or haze on the sensor dramatically reduces accuracy.
- Inspect the cable for breaks, especially near the strain-relief points at the gun and at the cabinet connector. Intermittent connection is a very common complaint.
- Confirm the trigger microswitch actuates cleanly and returns properly. Replace if sticky or unreliable.
- Test aiming across the full screen. If the gun is consistently off in one area, check monitor geometry and purity as well as the gun itself.
- Keep a known-good spare gun or cable if the machine will see heavy public use — light-gun failures are the most frequent service call on these titles.

5. Monitor (CRT — Critical for Gun Accuracy)

Most Deer Hunting USA cabinets use a Wells Gardner or similar CRT (U2000 and related chassis appear frequently). Because the light gun depends on the CRT's timing, keep the original CRT if at all possible for public placements.

- Clean the chassis and check fuses on the monitor.
- Confirm isolation-transformer power and reseat the neckboard.
- Address common CRT issues: weak brightness, focus problems, color purity, and geometry. A misaligned or unstable picture will make the gun feel inaccurate even if the gun itself is good.
- Cap kits and standard service procedures exist for the popular chassis used in these machines. Only attempt deeper CRT work if experienced and following proper discharge procedures.
- LCD conversion is generally not recommended for light-gun accuracy on this title unless a verified compatible solution is

used.

6. Power Supply, Boards & Connections

- Clean the power supply area and verify stable voltages under load.
- Check and replace oxidized or burned fuse holders.
- Reseat the game PCB and any related boards. Clean edge connectors.
- Inspect the gun harness and any control-panel wiring for loose or damaged connectors.
- Dust the interior thoroughly — heat and dust shorten the life of boards and the monitor chassis.

7. Sound, Coin Door & Interior

- Confirm the speaker produces clean sound at reasonable volume. Replace if distorted or weak.
- For free-play youth or community placements, set and document free-play or appropriate credit settings.
- Confirm the rear interlock switch (if present) functions for safety.
- Keep vents clear and the interior free of loose debris.

8. Final Testing Checklist Before Placement

- Full cold boot to attract mode with correct picture and sound
- Light gun tracks accurately across the full screen with consistent hits
- Trigger registers cleanly and returns every time
- Complete several full hunting rounds with no freezes or gun dropouts
- Monitor picture is focused, bright enough, and free of major geometry issues
- Cabinet exterior is clean, level, and free of sharp edges or loose parts
- Marquee is lit and readable
- Free-play or pricing configured correctly for the host site
- Keys, spare fuses, and basic notes bagged and labeled for the host organization

9. Notes for Host Sites

Provide a short one-page sheet: how to power the machine on/off, free-play status, and who to contact. Recommend a weekly wipe-down of the gun lens/window, control area, and glass. Ask the host to report any new gun inaccuracy, intermittent trigger, or picture changes early — small gun problems become big player frustration quickly. Document any non-original parts (gun, cable, monitor chassis work, etc.) so future volunteers know what they are looking at.

This guide is intended for educational and nonprofit service use by Coin Op 4 Charity and partner organizations. The goal is a Deer Hunting USA machine that stays accurate, reliable, and fun for the people who play it.

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